

IFNULL

= A "backup plan"

- You ask me: "What toy is in the box?"
- If the box is empty (**NULL**), I'll give you a teddy bear instead.
- If the box already has a toy, (like a car), I'll just give you that toy.

IFNULL

- ↳ Checks if something is empty (**NULL**)
- ↳ If it is empty, it gives you a replacement value.
- ↳ If it's not empty, it gives you the real value.

SYNTAX:

SELECT IFNULL (favourite_color, 'blue')

AS colour

FROM friends;

This means:

- If friend's favourite colour is missing (**NULL**), we'll say it's "blue".
- If we already have a colour, we keep it.
- "If you don't have an answer, I'll give you one."

Sales

product	Amount
Apple	100
Orange	0
Banana	20

SELECT product

IFNULL (Amount, 0) AS amount

FROM sales;

COALECE

- Imagine you are asking 3 friends for a toy:-

Friend 1 - their box is empty (**NULL**)

Friend 2 - their box is empty (**NULL**)

Friend 3 - they have a teddy bear.

So you take the teddy bear.

COALECE: Looks at the list of values and picks the **first one that isn't empty (NULL)**

↳ A way to replace null values by a value from alternative column or specified value.

↳ You have multiple options.

↳ Commonly used in our **SELECT** statement